

**DAILY PRACTICE PAPER –
14/05/2026**

Q 1. Which of the following is/are the discretionary powers of the Governor of a State?

1. Sending a report to the President for imposing President's rule.
2. Appointing the Ministers.
3. Reserving certain bills passed by the State Legislature for consideration of the President.
4. Conducting the business of the State Government.

Select the correct answer:

- A) 1 and 2 only
- B) 1 and 3 only
- C) 2, 3, and 4 only
- D) 1, 2, 3, and 4

Correct Answer: B (1 and 3 only)

Explanation: Appointing ministers and conducting government business are formal executive actions taken on the aid and advice of the Council of Ministers. Discretionary powers are those the Governor exercises independently, such as reporting under Article 356 or reserving bills under Article 200.

Q 2. With reference to 'Ocean Mean Temperature' (OMT), consider the following statements:

1. OMT is measured up to a depth of 26°C isotherm which is 129 meters in the south-western Indian Ocean during January-March.

2. OMT is better at predicting monsoon rainfall than Sea Surface Temperature (SST).

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- A) 1 only
- B) 2 only
- C) Both 1 and 2
- D) Neither 1 nor 2

Correct Answer: C (Both 1 and 2)

Explanation: Unlike SST, which only measures the "skin" layer of the ocean, OMT measures the heat content of a deeper layer. This provides a more stable and accurate indicator of the energy available to fuel the monsoon.

Q 3. The 'Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms' of 1919 introduced which of the following?

1. Diarchy in the provincial governments.
2. Separate electorates for Muslims for the first time.
3. A bicameral legislature at the Center.

Select the correct answer:

- A) 1 only
- B) 1 and 3 only
- C) 2 and 3 only
- D) 1, 2, and 3

Correct Answer: B (1 and 3 only)

Explanation: Separate electorates for Muslims were introduced earlier by the Morley-Minto Reforms (1909). The 1919 Act extended them to Sikhs and Christians, introduced **Diarchy** (dual government) in provinces, and established a bicameral central legislature.

Q 4. Which of the following would lead to an 'Appreciation' of the Indian Rupee?

1. An increase in the inflow of Foreign Institutional Investment (FII).
2. A sharp rise in global crude oil prices.
3. An increase in the interest rates by the US Federal Reserve.

Select the correct answer:

- A) 1 only
- B) 1 and 2 only
- C) 2 and 3 only
- D) 1, 2, and 3

Correct Answer: A (1 only)

Explanation: High FII inflow increases the demand for Rupees, leading to appreciation. Rising oil prices and US Fed rate hikes lead to an outflow of Dollars, which causes the Rupee to depreciate.

Q 5. What is the 'Blue Carbon' exactly?

- A) Carbon captured by the world's ocean and coastal ecosystems.
- B) Carbon sequestered in deep geological formations.
- C) Carbon stored in the biomass of the tropical rainforests.

D) Carbon emitted by the combustion of high-sulfur coal.

Correct Answer: A (Carbon captured by oceans/coastal ecosystems)

Explanation: Blue Carbon refers to carbon stored in coastal and marine ecosystems like mangroves, seagrasses, and salt marshes. These ecosystems sequester carbon at much higher rates per area than terrestrial forests.

Q 6. The 'Kulashekhara Alwar' and 'Andal' are associated with which religious movement?

- A) Virashaivism in Karnataka.
- B) Bhakti movement in South India (Vaishnavism).
- C) Sramana tradition of Magadha.
- D) Kashmiri Shaivism.

Correct Answer: B (Bhakti movement - Vaishnavism)

Explanation: The Alwars were Tamil poet-saints of South India who advocated devotion to Lord Vishnu. Andal was the only female Alwar among the twelve.

Q 7. Why is 'Zeolite' frequently used in water softeners and as a catalyst in the petrochemical industry?

- A) Because it has a high capacity to absorb UV radiation.
- B) Because of its porous, honeycomb-like structure that allows for ion exchange.
- C) Because it is a strong oxidizing agent.

D) Because it can lower the boiling point of heavy oils.

Correct Answer: B (Porous structure for ion exchange)

Explanation: Zeolites are aluminosilicate minerals. Their "molecular sieve" structure allows them to trap calcium and magnesium ions (hardness) and exchange them for sodium ions, thus softening water.

Q 8. In the Mauryan administration, the term 'Sitadhyaksha' referred to the officer in charge of:

- A) Royal Mint and Coinage.
- B) Customs and Tolls.
- C) Crown Lands and Agriculture.
- D) Weights and Measures.

Correct Answer: C (Crown Lands and Agriculture)

Explanation: According to Kautilya's *Arthashastra*, the Sitadhyaksha supervised the cultivation of crown lands (Sita) and managed agricultural production, which was a primary revenue source.

Q 9. Which of the following statements regarding the 'Thorium' reserves in India is correct?

1. India has the largest reserves of Thorium in the world.
2. It is primarily found in the Monazite sands of the Kerala coast.
3. Thorium can be used directly as fuel in a nuclear reactor without any transmutation.

Select the correct answer:

A) 1 and 2 only

B) 2 only

C) 2 and 3 only

D) 1, 2, and 3

Correct Answer: A (1 and 2 only)

Explanation: India holds significant Thorium reserves in Monazite sands. However, Thorium-232 is fertile, not fissile. It must be transmuted into Uranium-233 in a fast breeder reactor before it can be used as fuel.

Q 10. Consider a 'Total Internal Reflection' (TIR). Which conditions must be met for TIR to occur?

1. Light must travel from a denser medium to a rarer medium.
2. The angle of incidence must be less than the critical angle.
3. Light must travel from a rarer medium to a denser medium.

Select the correct answer:

A) 1 only

B) 2 only

C) 1 and 2

D) 3 only

Correct Answer: A (1 only)

Explanation: For TIR, light must move from a denser to a rarer medium (e.g., water to air). Crucially, the angle of incidence must be greater (not less) than the critical angle for the light to be reflected back into the denser medium.